

Before you trust a health claim...

Use these five checks to decide how much confidence to place in what you've found.

1

Identify the claim

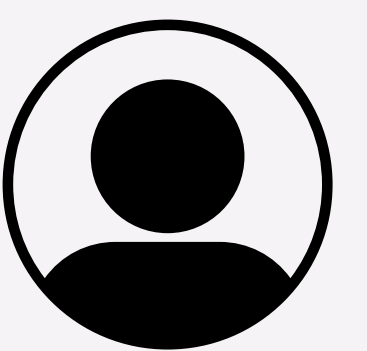


What is actually being claimed?

Separate the health claim from the headline, imagery or persuasive language around it.

2

Check who's behind it



Who created or published the information?

Look at their relevant expertise, organisation, purpose and any interests that might influence how the information is presented.

3

Look for support

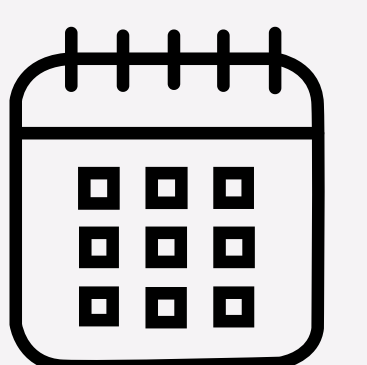


Who supports the claim?

Look for clear sources or evidence. Be cautious of vague phrases such as "research shows" without anything you can follow up.

4

Check the context



Is the information current and relevant?

Consider when and where it was published, who it applies to and whether important detail or limitations are missing.

5

Check elsewhere



What do independent sources say?

Compare the claim with an appropriate, authoritative source before deciding whether to rely on it.